Newsletter April 2022

Dear Members, Supporters, Patrons and Friends

We hope you are all well.

After two difficult years during which we had to put the majority of London Kalibari's functions and activities on hold, we had hoped to start off 2022 on a positive note after completing the purchase of 18 Byron Road, Wealdstone, Harrow, Middlesex HA3 7ST in December 2021. This means we now have a permanent home for London Kalibari (LKB).

LKB ACTIVITIES AND FUNCTIONS ON HOLD DUE TO LEAK FROM ABOVE

We had plans to mark Pohela Boishakh by holding a Narayan Puja on 17th April 2022 within LKB's ground floor premises. Unfortunately, we have had to put all such plans on hold as the puja room at 18 Byron Road has been badly damaged by a leak that is coming from above – hence we are unable to organise any gathering within the premises until repairs are carried out.

When the repairs are carried out, we are also hoping to carry out the renovations that so many of you generously contributed towards.

RESIGNATION AND APPOINTMENT OF LKB TRUSTEES

Over the past few months, Dr Sudin Mandal (Chair) and Mrs Debjani Sengupta have stepped down from the board of trustees after many decades of charitable service to London Kalibari. We would like to thank both for all the hard work, time and dedication they put in to make London Kalibari what it is today. Debjani Sengupta will remain among the core support group.

As a result of the resignations, Dr Satya Chatterjee was elected as our new Chair and two new trustees, Mr Debabrata Dey and Miss Pritha Sarkar, have come on board. Debabrata Dey was elected as our new Treasurer.

In the meantime, we wanted to update you on some of the initiatives the trustees have been pursing over the past few months:

PURCHASE OF TALLER PROTIMA FROM INDIA AND KALIBARI FUNCTIONS

- We are in negotiations to purchase a fibreglass Protima from India for the main Kali Puja - this is as a result of observations made by many patrons who said that the existing effigy is too small for the annual event.
- Getting the new Protima will also ensure our existing Ma has a permanent home in LKB as she will always remain within the 18 Byron Road building.
- Once the building work (ie repairs and renovations) has been completed, we plan to open the temple on a more regular basis and re-introduce the luncheon club.



REVAMP OF LKB WEBSITE

- We are also planning to revamp the LKB website and include sections honouring:

1. The founders of London Kalibari
2. All those who held elected positions on the board of trustees
3. Non-trustees who have made notable contributions to Kalibari

If you have any information that can help in the write-up of these pages, please feel free to approach any trustee as all contributions will be greatly received. Contributions can also be emailed to: **kalibarilondon@gmail.com**

FUTURE DONATIONS

- We have acquired a machine to facilitate cashless donations

UPDATING LKB MAILING LIST AND MEETING GDPR REQUIREMENTS

- Your privacy is important to us and we would like to communicate with you about London Kalibari and its activities. **To do so we need your consent. If you object to any of the following, then please let us know at kalibarilondon@gmail.com and we will remove your details from our database.**

  From 25 May 2018 the new General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR) gives an individual more control over how their personal information is used. A brief explanation is given below on what data about you we use and your rights.

  1. London Kalibari keeps your individual data such as your name, postal address and email address only for the purpose of informing you about forthcoming events of London Kalibari. We do not share your data with any other organisations or individuals.
  2. You can at any time withdraw your consent, view the information kept about you and ask to delete part or all of the information on you.
  3. You can lodge a complaint about misuse of information by speaking to one of the trustees.

We look forward to seeing you all soon and thank you for your continuing support.

Best wishes
London Kalibari Trustees: Dr Satya Chatterjee, Mrs Jayati Das, Mr Debabrata Dey, Mrs Krishna Ghosh, Mrs Rama Choudhury, Miss Pritha Sarkar